

AgenThink Council — Torcetrapib Retrospective

Phase II → III Advancement Decision | Evidence Cutoff: December 31, 2005 | Council Run: June 2026

The Decision | Field | Value | |---|---| | **Drug** | Torcetrapib | | **Company** | Pfizer | | **Mechanism** | CETP inhibitor (raises HDL-C) | | **Phase II result** | HDL +72% · BP +2 mmHg systolic | | **Decision date** | 2005 | | **Decision made** | Advance to Phase III (ILLUMINATE) | ## The Signal > Phase II blood pressure elevation of +2 mmHg systolic was statistically significant and mechanistically unexplained. CETP inhibition should not directly affect blood pressure. No mechanistic investigation was completed before Phase III advancement. ****Constitutional rule triggered:**** PC-002 — Unexplained safety signals require mechanistic investigation before advancement.

Council Verdict ###
WAIT | Vote | Count | |---|---|
- | | GO | **0** | | WAIT |
8 | | NO-GO | **2** |
****Proof Score: 93 / 100****
*10 personas · Pharma
Constitution v1 · Pre-
decision evidence only*

Council Blockers

Rule	Trigger	Invoked By
PC-001	BP signal requires pre-specified stopping rules	Biostatistician, Safety Expert
PC-002	Unexplained safety signal requires mechanistic investigation	Safety Expert, Pharmacologist, Skeptic
PC-003	Financial pressure documented as potential bias	Portfolio Manager, Devil's Advocate

The Outcome

ILLUMINATE terminated: December 2, 2006

Metric	Value
Deaths (torcetrapib arm)	82
Deaths (control arm)	51
Write-off	\$800M
Market cap loss	\$21B (−10.6% in one session)
Mechanism confirmed	Forrest et al. 2008 — off-target aldosterone stimulation

Retrospective alignment: ✓ Council verdict was correct.

Limitation

The council was run using a large language model. We cannot verify that the model's training data did not include post-failure information about torcetrapib. The evidence manifest (23 documents, all pre-December 2005, all DOI-cited) is available for independent review.

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Full methodology: github.com/agentthinkmesh/pharma-council-v1 · Evidence manifest: 23 documents · All pre-December 2005